

BUILDING BLOCKS — Part 2

Problems of Tribal Communities | Anthropology Paper 2 | Quick Revision

Format: Each block = standard content (Scholar + Case Study + Data + Quotable + Use in) followed by a memory aid (mnemonic / flow diagram / hook). Learn 14 blocks → answer any tribal problems question.

LAND ALIENATION (Blocks 1-3)

BLOCK 1 — Land = Identity

Land alienation / Root cause / Tribal unrest

Scholar	 L.P. Vidyarthi — "Land alienation is root cause of all tribal unrest"  Dhebar Commission — "Loss of land = loss of livelihood, dignity, identity"
Case Study	Koraput, Odisha — tribal landholdings fell over 50% between 1970-1990 (Xaxa, 2001) Khuntkatti (Mundas) and Bhuinhari (Oraons) — collective ownership systems collapsed
Data	50% land loss in 20 years (Koraput); land = economic resource + social identity + cultural continuity + ecological survival
Quotable	<i>"Land is not merely an economic resource — it is the basis of social identity, cultural continuity, and ecological survival"</i>
Govt Initiative	FRA 2006 (individual + community forest rights); LARR Act 2013 (fair compensation); Chotanagpur Tenancy Act 1908 & Santhal Pargana Tenancy Act 1949 (restrict land transfer to non-tribals)
Anthro Significance	Land = total social fact (not just economic) — ties together identity, kinship, ritual, and ecology. Collapse of collective systems like Khuntkatti/Bhuinhari shows how market forces disintegrate tribal social organisation

Use in: Land alienation, tribal unrest, displacement, cultural erosion, tribal identity, forest rights, development critique

MEMORY AID

L. D. K. — "Land Defines Kabilas (tribes)"

- | | |
|----------|--|
| L | L.P. Vidyarthi — Land = root of all unrest |
| D | Dhebar — land loss = dignity loss |
| K | Koraput — 50% gone; Khuntkatti collapsed |

BLOCK 2 — Development = Displacement

Dams / Mining / Resistance / Co-existence

Scholar	 Walter Fernandes — links displacement to development-induced impoverishment
Case Study	Narmada Valley — 2 lakh displaced, majority Adivasis, Narmada Bachao Andolan (1985) Kanha Tiger Reserve (2014) — 450 Baiga/Gond families evicted Soliga (Biligirirangana Hills) — allowed to stay, tiger population increased
Data	Narmada: 30 major + 135 medium + 3,000 small dams ; Karanpura: 75,000 ha acquired in Jharkhand
Quotable	<i>"Displacement is not development — it is impoverishment with a different name"</i>
Govt Initiative	LARR Act 2013 (consent + R&R mandatory); FRA 2006 (community forest rights before diversion); National R&R Policy 2007 ; Wildlife Protection Act 1972 (amended to allow co-existence)
Anthro Significance	Development-induced displacement challenges the modernisation paradigm — proves that "development" without consent = cultural genocide. Soliga case shows indigenous ecological knowledge can serve conservation better than exclusion

Use in: Displacement, R&R, dams, mining, tribal resistance, environment vs development, FRA, LARR Act, national parks, co-existence models

MEMORY AID

Fernandes warns: Dam → Displaced → Deprived

3 cases, 3 outcomes:

Narmada = mass displacement (2 lakh) | Kanha = eviction (450 families) | Soliga = co-existence (tigers increased)

Remember: "NKS" — Narmada Kicked, Soliga Stayed

BLOCK 3 — Class Within Tribe

Internal stratification / Moneylender exploitation

Scholar	 B.K. Roy Burman — class differentiation within the tribe after land alienation
Case Study	Tharu & Bhoksa (U.P.) — post-Partition refugee moneylenders offered loans, grabbed land through fraudulent contracts
Data	New landlord tribals emerge; others become dependent labourers — traditional egalitarianism breaks
Quotable	<i>"Alienation creates two classes within the tribe — the new landlord and the new labourer"</i>
Govt Initiative	Fifth Schedule (Governor regulates land transfer in Scheduled Areas); PESA 1996 (Gram Sabha must approve land acquisition); state-level anti-alienation laws (AP, MP, Jharkhand)
Anthro Significance	Challenges egalitarian thesis of tribal society — market penetration creates internal stratification, contradicting the romanticised view. Shows transition from mechanical to organic solidarity (Durkheim) within tribal societies

Use in: Social stratification, tribal egalitarianism breakdown, moneylender exploitation, land consequences, class formation in tribes

MEMORY AID

Roy Burman = "Roy" (king) vs "Burman" (common)

Land alienation splits tribe into **kings** (new landlords) and **commons** (labourers)

Case: Tharu — Tricked by moneylenders

BLOCK 4 — Women Bear the Worst

Gender / Land rights / Health / Trafficking

Scholar	NFHS-5 — 60% ST women anaemic; maternal mortality 167 per lakh (higher than national avg) Xaxa Committee (2014) — early marriage and chores reduce girls' schooling
Case Study	Polavaram Dam (A.P.) — female-headed households least compensated, most food insecure Baiga/Gond women (M.P.) — once managed Bewar fields, now daily wage labour Santhal women — 12+ hour workdays (ICSSR); eat last and least
Data	60% anaemic, 167 maternal mortality, 12+ hr workday ; women eat last, compensated last
Quotable	<i>"Displacement is negotiated with men — women are left without ownership or compensation"</i>
Govt Initiative	AMSY (Adivasi Mahila Sashaktikaran Yojana — 4% loans for ST women); FRA 2006 (joint pattas in name of both spouses); Poshan Abhiyaan (targets anaemia in tribal women); National Menstrual Hygiene Scheme
Anthro Significance	Gendered impact of development — displacement disrupts women's role as custodians of food security and forest knowledge. Challenges the myth of tribal gender equality — shows patriarchal compensation structures coexist with matrilineal traditions

Use in: Tribal women, gender & displacement, women's autonomy, land rights, nutrition, maternal health, trafficking — ANY "impact on women" question

MEMORY AID

Women: LAST in everything

Last to eat | **Last** to be compensated | **Last** to be consulted

3 cases: **Polavaram** = no compensation, **Baiga** = field to wage, **Santhal** = 12hr day

"PBS" — Polavaram, Baiga, Santhal

POVERTY (Blocks 5-6)

BLOCK 5 — Five Stairs Down

B.D. Sharma's framework / Structural deprivation / Poverty cascade

Scholar	 B.D. Sharma — Five Levels of Deprivation: (1) Rights denied (2) Means lost (3) Wages cheated (4) Liberty sold (5) Spirit broken
Case Study	Adivasi tea workers (Assam) — earn less than non-tribals for same work (Level 3) Tribal women in Jharkhand/Odisha — trafficked due to poverty (Level 4)
Data	STs BPL: rural 45.3%, urban 24.1% (2011-12) — poorest among all groups; declined from 62.3% (2004-05) but still worst
Quotable	<i>"Tribals are not poor by culture, but made poor by circumstance"</i>
Govt Initiative	TSP (1974-75) (plan funds proportional to tribal population); IRDP (assisted 42% tribal families); MGNREGA (20% workers are STs); PM-JANMAN 2024 (for PVTGs); Van Dhan Yojana (MFP value addition)
Anthro Significance	Poverty as structural violence (not cultural deficit) — B.D. Sharma's framework rejects the "culture of poverty" thesis. Shows how colonial + post-colonial policies created systemic marginalisation , making poverty a consequence of integration, not isolation

Use in: Tribal poverty, structural exclusion, bonded labour, trafficking, deprivation framework, multi-dimensional poverty — this framework structures ANY poverty answer

MEMORY AID

R - M - W - L - S "Rights, Means, Wages, Liberty, Spirit"

Rights denied → Means lost → Wages cheated → Liberty sold → Spirit broken

Think of it as a person falling 5 stairs — each step causes the next

Forest taken → Becomes labourer → Paid half → Daughter trafficked → Gives up fighting

Scholar	 D.N. Majumdar — "tribal poverty is not merely economic but an outcome of dislocation from the ecological niche"  B.D. Sharma — "the tribal world is being impoverished in the name of development"
Case Study	Saharias (Kuno, M.P.) — Asmita Kabra (2009): 80% lived below poverty line after losing forest produce access post-relocation
Data	80% BPL after relocation ; India's growth (Green Revolution, industrialisation, urbanisation) bypassed subsistence tribal economy
Quotable	<i>"The tribal world is being impoverished in the name of development"</i>
Govt Initiative	FRA 2006 (restores forest access — addresses root cause); TRIFED (marketing of MFP); Community Forest Resource Rights under FRA (community manages forests); Indian Forest Act 1927 (the colonial cause — still partly operative)
Anthro Significance	Ecological niche concept — Majumdar shows tribes exist in symbiosis with their habitat; removing the habitat destroys the society. Supports Vidyarthi's Nature-Man-Spirit Complex — economy, ecology, and belief form an integrated system that cannot be separated

Use in: Root causes of poverty, ecological displacement, colonial legacy, forest policy, MFP loss, national parks displacement, development critique

MEMORY AID

Majumdar = "M" = Mismatch — tribe dislocated from its ecological niche

Saharia = "S" = Severed — 80% BPL after being severed from forest

Poverty = not lack of money, but loss of ecosystem

INDEBTEDNESS (Blocks 7-8)

BLOCK 7 — Barter to Bondage

Monetisation / Moneylenders / Bonded labour

Scholar	 Christoph von Fürer-Haimendorf — shift from barter to monetised economy exposed tribals to moneylenders  Rangarajan — 36% of ST farmer households indebted to non-institutional sources
Case Study	Sahariya (Baran, Rajasthan) — Hali system of bonded labour despite Abolition Act 1976 Juang PVTG (Odisha) — Goti system binds families into labour for generations
Data	36% ST farmers indebted ; mostly to non-institutional sources (moneylenders, traders)
Quotable	<i>"Good laws, bad implementation — true catharsis occurs only when policy translates into freedom from debt, bondage, and indignity"</i>
Govt Initiative	Bonded Labour Abolition Act 1976 ; Fifth Schedule (regulates moneylending in Scheduled Areas); NSTFDC (concessional credit for STs); AP Scheduled Areas Moneylenders Regulation 1963 ; M.P. 2019 — waived all loans from unlicensed moneylenders
Anthro Significance	Transition from reciprocity to market exchange — Fürer-Haimendorf documents how monetisation disrupted tribal economic systems based on barter and mutual obligation. Classic example of how contact with dominant economy transforms and exploits subsistence societies

Use in: Indebtedness, bonded labour, monetisation impact, moneylender exploitation, colonial economic legacy, PVTGs, legislative failure

MEMORY AID

Barter → Money → Moneylender → Bondage

Fürer-Haimendorf = "the Foreign scholar who saw the Fall from barter to bondage"

Two **bonded labour systems**: Hali (Sahariya) + Goti (Juang) = "**HG**"

36% indebted — *"more than 1 in 3 tribal farmers in debt"*

BLOCK 8 — Debt Destroys Families

Trafficking / Health impacts / Bonded labour persists

Scholar	 Anumeha Yadav — Goti bonded labour persists despite laws  V.G. Rao — 36.5% STD prevalence among tribal villagers (Jabalpur study)
Case Study	Bedia community — women pushed into prostitution as debt-repayment Ho & Munda women (Jharkhand/Odisha) — sent as domestic servants through exploitative networks
Data	Bonded Labour Act 1976 + Orissa Debt Act 1948 — both widely violated in practice
Quotable	<i>"Indebtedness is both a cause and a consequence of underdevelopment"</i>
Govt Initiative	Orissa Debt Bondage Abolition Act 1948 ; MCF Scheme (micro credit for SHGs — up to 5 lakh per SHG); AMSY (loans at 4% for tribal women); Anti-trafficking provisions under ITPA and Criminal Law Amendment Act 2013
Anthro Significance	Shows how debt becomes a mechanism of social control — Hali and Goti systems are forms of institutionalised exploitation that persist despite legal abolition, proving that law without structural change cannot end embedded socio-economic relations

Use in: Indebtedness consequences, human trafficking, bonded labour, tribal women, health impacts, legislative failure, migration & exploitation

MEMORY AID

Debt → 3 D's: Domestic slavery (Ho/Munda) | Degradation (Bedia) | Disease (V.G. Rao - 36.5%)

Two Acts, both fail: 1976 (Bonded Labour) + 1948 (Orissa Debt) = *"laws on paper, bondage on ground"*

EDUCATION (Blocks 9-10)

BLOCK 9 — Education of the Forest

Language barrier / Cultural alienation / Dropout

Scholar	 Verrier Elwin — "Education must be of the forest and not against the forest" "Let us teach the tribe not to despise his culture, but to enrich it through knowledge"
Case Study	Gonds (M.P.) — Hindi-medium education culturally alien, difficult to relate Chenchu/Konda Reddi PVTGs (A.P.) — girls leave after Class V, no female teachers or hostels
Data	ST literacy 59% vs national 73% (Census 2011); ST female below 50%; gender gap nearly 20 points; Mizoram highest (91.6%), A.P. lowest (49.2%)
Quotable	<i>"Curriculum and language of instruction are alien to tribal worldview — schools alienate rather than empower"</i>
Govt Initiative	EMRS (Eklavya Model Residential Schools); NEP 2020 (bilingual education + local knowledge); Art 350A (mother tongue instruction); MLE Programme (Odisha 2006) — 3,385 tribal teachers + dictionaries in 20 languages; KISS Odisha — validates 10 tribal dialects
Anthro Significance	Elwin's principle = education as cultural continuity , not cultural replacement. Mainstream education imposes dominant cultural values on tribal children — a form of symbolic violence (Bourdieu). Language barrier exemplifies how linguistic imperialism marginalises indigenous knowledge systems

Use in: Tribal education, language barrier, dropout, cultural alienation, girls' education, NEP 2020, bilingual education, EMRS, Article 350A

MEMORY AID

Elwin = "E" = Education OF forest, not AGAINST forest
59 vs 73 — remember as "ST literacy is **14 behind**"
Two extremes: Mizoram = Miraculous (91.6%) | A.P. = Awful (49.2%)

BLOCK 10 — Elite Capture

Education consequences / Tribal elite / Institutional abuse

Scholar	S.C. Dube (1955) — educated intermediaries form tribal elite serving self-interest Xaxa Committee (2014) — early marriage and household chores reduce girls' schooling
Case Study	Maharashtra — 29 tribal girls exploited in hostels (2011-2016) Muzaffarpur shelter case — abuse in residential institutions
Data	ST male 68.5% vs female below 50% — nearly 20-point gender gap in literacy
Quotable	<i>"Education creates tribal elites who serve self-interest rather than community welfare"</i>
Govt Initiative	Pre-Matric & Post-Matric Scholarships for ST students; Art 15(4) (special provisions for educational advancement); Art 275(1) (grants for tribal welfare/education); Ashram Schools in remote areas; Adivasi Mahila Shikshan Kendra (literacy for tribal women)
Anthro Significance	Elite formation within tribal society — education creates a new class that mediates between tribe and state (Dube's "educated intermediary"). Raises the insider-outsider dilemma — educated tribals may become agents of the dominant culture rather than advocates for their community

Use in: Education consequences, tribal leadership, gender disparity, safety in institutions, Xaxa Committee, elite formation, women's education

MEMORY AID

Dube = "D" for Double-edged — education empowers some, creates elite who exploit others
Xaxa = "X" marks the problem — early marriage kills girls' education
68 vs 50 — "men 68, women can't even reach 50"

BLOCK 11 — Quitting Farming, No Alternative

Informal economy / Reservation vacant / Skill gap

Scholar	 Richard Mahapatra — "tribals quitting farming fast, every second household in informal economy"  Saiyed Zegham Murtaza — "extreme disregard of reservation norms"
Case Study	112th Parliamentary Standing Committee (2023) — 1,199 of 3,097 ST-reserved posts in 45 central universities remain vacant; over 3,000 in ministries
Data	75% in agriculture (subsistence); only 4.8% in regular/salaried jobs ; less than 2% formally skilled
Quotable	<i>"These figures betray an extreme disregard of the reservation norms"</i>
Govt Initiative	MGNREGA (STs = 20% of workers); NSTFDC (concessional loans for entrepreneurship); VTCs (Vocational Training Centres); India's First Tribal Employment Exchange (Trivandrum, 2018) ; Skill Development Scheme for ST students (2018-19)
Anthro Significance	Proletarianisation of tribal communities — shift from self-sufficient subsistence to wage dependency reflects forced integration into capitalist economy. Vacant reservation posts show how structural discrimination persists despite constitutional safeguards

Use in: Tribal unemployment, reservation failure, informal economy, skill gap, distress migration, agricultural crisis, governance failure

MEMORY AID

75 - 5 - 2 rule: 75% in farming | only 5% salaried | only 2% skilled
Mahapatra = "M" for Mass exodus from farming
Murtaza = "M" for Missing reservation — 1,199 posts vacant in universities
"Two M's complaining: one about farming, one about jobs"

Scholar	 Bhatia — studies in Bastar link unemployment with Naxal recruitment  N.C. Saxena — agriculture and forest work limited to 4-5 months, rest casual labour
Case Study	Bastar — 70% of employed tribal women = seasonal MGNREGA labourers, earn less than men Jharkhand/Odisha — mass migration to brick kilns in A.P., factories in Surat/Mumbai
Data	MGNREGA: ST share dropped from 36% to 17-20% ; STs form 20% of workers (twice their population share)
Quotable	<i>"Joblessness fuels frustration, alcoholism, and susceptibility to extremism"</i>
Govt Initiative	JRY (Jawahar Rozgar Yojana); Start-Up India (with NSTFDC funding for tribal youth); MGNREGA (but ST share dropped from 36% to 17-20%); LWE Security Related Expenditure Scheme (addresses extremism in tribal areas)
Anthro Significance	Unemployment as root cause of extremism — validates the deprivation theory of social movements. Seasonal unemployment shows how ecological rhythm of tribal economy clashes with modern employment structures; distress migration disrupts kinship networks and community bonds

Use in: Naxalism/LWE, unemployment consequences, seasonal work, distress migration, MGNREGA critique, Bastar, extremism root causes

MEMORY AID

4 months work → 8 months idle → Migration or Naxalism

Bhatia = Bastar = Bombs (unemployment → Naxalism)

Saxena = Seasonal (4-5 months work only)

MGNREGA: "36 to 17" — tribal participation halved

BLOCK 13 — Prosperity Without Well-being

Health paradox / Mining wealth / Triple disease burden

Scholar	Abhay Bang Committee (2018) — tribal India faces triple burden : communicable diseases + NCDs + mental health
Case Study	Keonjhar, Odisha — 26% of India's iron ore, ₹15,000 crore in mineral funds, yet worst child/maternal health; 74.7% pregnant women anaemic; villages 20+ km from hospital
Data	STs: 30% of malaria cases, 60% of P. falciparum, 50% of malaria deaths TB: 703 vs 256 per lakh nationally; life expectancy 63.9 vs 67 years; 45% children stunted
Quotable	<i>"A paradox of prosperity without well-being — extractive wealth flows out while health deprivation stays"</i>
Govt Initiative	NHM (tribal sub-plans + ASHA workers); Aashwasan Campaign 2022 (TB screening in 177 tribal districts — 10M people); Malaria Elimination Programme 2030 ; ICDS (nutrition for children/mothers); Poshan Abhiyaan (targets stunting/anaemia)
Anthro Significance	Resource curse / paradox of prosperity — Keonjhar proves extractive development benefits the state but not the indigenous population. Triple disease burden shows tribal communities bear the health cost of both underdevelopment AND industrial development simultaneously

Use in: Tribal health, mining impact, resource curse, health infrastructure, malaria/TB, malnutrition, maternal health, development critique

MEMORY AID

Triple burden = CMD: Communicable + Mental + Developmental (NCDs)

Keonjhar paradox: "richest soil, sickest people" — **26% iron ore, 74% anaemic mothers**

Malaria: 30-60-50 rule — 30% cases, 60% falciparum, 50% deaths

"Bang" Committee — the name itself says "wake up!"

BLOCK 14 — Gadchiroli Solution

Community health / Traditional medicine / Success model

Scholar	 P.C. Joshi — integration of ethnomedicine with PHCs could improve outcomes Dr. Abhay & Rani Bang — SEARCH initiative in Gadchiroli
Case Study	Gadchiroli, Maharashtra — SEARCH trained village health workers for home-based newborn care → reduced neonatal mortality Formula: community participation + local training + traditional integration
Data	PHC shortfall: 27-40% in tribal areas; 33% shortage of doctors; 45% tribal children stunted (NFHS-5)
Quotable	<i>"Tribal health is a test of India's commitment to equity"</i> — Abhay Bang Committee
Govt Initiative	Abhay Bang Committee 2018 (roadmap for tribal health — decentralised planning); SWASTHYA Portal (digital tribal health data); Mobile Medical Units in remote areas; ASHAs/ANMs from tribal communities (build trust); proposed National Tribal Health Mission (NTHM)
Anthro Significance	Ethnomedicine integration (P.C. Joshi) — recognising indigenous healing systems alongside modern medicine respects medical pluralism . Gadchiroli model proves community-based participatory health works better than top-down biomedical interventions in tribal contexts

Use in: Health solutions, community participation, AYUSH integration, traditional medicine, way forward for ANY health question, NHM, decentralised planning, success stories

MEMORY AID

SEARCH = Solution: train locals, trust tradition, treat at home
P.C. Joshi = "P" for PHC + ethnomedicine Partnership
Gadchiroli = the ONE success story — always use in "way forward"
"Bang solved it, Joshi theorised it" — use both together

BLOCK COMBINATIONS — "If UPSC asks about X, pick these"

Question Theme	Blocks	Must-drop scholar	Must-use case
Land alienation	B1 + B2 + B3	L.P. Vidyarthi, Dhebar	Koraput, Narmada
Displacement / R&R	B2 + B4 + B6	Walter Fernandes, Kabra	Narmada, Saharias, Soliga
Tribal women / gender	B4 + B8 + B9	NFHS-5, Xaxa	Polavaram, Bedia, Chenchu
Poverty / deprivation	B5 + B6 + B7	B.D. Sharma, Majumdar	Assam tea, Saharias
Indebtedness / bonded labour	B7 + B8 + B3	Fürer-Haimendorf, Yadav	Sahariya-Hali, Juang-Goti
Education	B9 + B10 + B4	Verrier Elwin, Xaxa	Gonds, KISS Odisha
Unemployment / Naxalism	B11 + B12 + B5	Mahapatra, Bhatia	Bastar, MGNREGA data
Health / nutrition	B13 + B14 + B6	Abhay Bang, P.C. Joshi	Keonjhar, Gadchiroli
Development critique	B2 + B5 + B6 + B13	Sharma, Fernandes, Majumdar	Keonjhar, Narmada, Saharias
Impact on women (any topic)	B4 + B8 + B10	NFHS-5, Anumeha Yadav	Polavaram, Bedia, Maharashtra
Legislative failure	B7 + B8 + B11	Murtaza, Anumeha Yadav	Hali + Goti persist, 1199 vacant posts

Way forward /
solutions

B14 + B5 + B9

Bang, Elwin, Sharma

Gadchiroli, EMRS, FRA